

An Unofficial Catalogue of Visual Double Open Clusters

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This catalogue is a running list of the visual double open clusters I come across at the eyepiece. My working definition: any pair of open clusters that shares the same field of view in my 12-inch SkyWatcher Dob with a 35 mm Panoptic eyepiece — a true field of about 1.6°. Southern-hemisphere focused; a work in progress.

Pair	Constellation	RA (J2000)	Dec (J2000)	Mag	Observing notes
NGC 3572 NGC 3590	Carina	11h 10.4m 11h 13.0m	-60° 15' -60° 47'	6.6 8.2	In the 35 mm Panoptic both clusters share the field with a loose clump of stars between them - the impression is of three interacting clusters, and it is genuinely hard to tell where one ends and the next begins. Two bright patches of nebulosity (NGC 3579/3603) sit in the same view. (Apr 2026)
IC 2714 Mel 105	Carina	11h 17.5m 11h 19.7m	-62° 44' -63° 29'	8.2 8.5	Halfway along the line from IC 2602 to lambda Centauri. In the 35 mm Panoptic both clusters fit in the same field for a lovely contrast: IC 2714 a large, relatively dense disk of 60+ stars spread across ~15', Mel 105 packed into just ~5' with only a few members resolved at low power. Highlighted as a pair by O'Meara in 'Deep-Sky Companions: Southern Gems'. (Apr 2026)
IC 2602 Mel 101	Carina	10h 43.0m 10h 42.2m	-64° 24' -65° 06'	1.9 8.0	A slightly asymmetric pair. IC 2602 (the Southern Pleiades) is too large for any eyepiece - best appreciated in binoculars or the finderscope - but nearby Mel 101 tucks into the edge of its field as a modest cluster of 30-40 stars forming a clear 'figure-8' shape. Comfortably squeezed into a single field with a small refractor. Not physically associated: Mel 101 lies ~14x more distant than IC 2602. (Apr / Jul 2026)
NGC 6200 NGC 6204	Ara	16h 44.1m 16h 46.2m	-47° 28' -47° 01'	7.4 8.2	With NGC 6193 centred in the finder, this pair drops together into one 35 mm field - a great contrasting pair. NGC 6200 is the tight, densely packed one: 30+ stars, with a chain of four brighter stars tapering off the top. NGC 6204 sits on the other side as a small, dense knot with a triplet of bright stars hanging off one edge. Observed in the Club 17.5"; would fit the 12" field too. (Sep 2025 & Jul 2026)
NGC 6134 Hogg 19	Norma	16h 27.8m 16h 29.0m	-49° 09' -49° 07'	7.2 -	NGC 6134 is a dense circular disk of 60+ stars across ~10', easy to pick out from the rich Norma star fields even against a nebulous background. A second, smaller knot of stars off to one side is the sparse open cluster Hogg 19, sitting about a quarter of a degree away. Observed in the Club 17.5"; would fit the 12" field too. Hogg 19 has no catalogued V magnitude. (Jul 2026)

Positions and magnitudes cross-checked between Stellarium and SIMBAD when each object entered the catalogue. Full observing notes, DSS plates and finder charts for each individual cluster are available at deepskynotes.com.